West conflict and China. The intelligence report suggested that China had dropped sharply in general esteem primarily for its interference in Tibet and its border problems with India. However, Russia continued to be most frequently cited as India's 'real best friend,' with the USA and the UK tied for second place. Pakistan was identified as the chief 'danger to India,' but Russia and the

USA were regarded as the greatest danger to world peace.

In the early 1960s, the focus of US intelligence shifted to India's nuclear programmes. Their primary aim was to assess India's nuclear capability. An intelligence report from October 1964 reveals the CIA's penetration and big brotherly attitude:

The Indian government has all the elements necessary to produce a nuclear weapon and it has the capability to assemble a bomb quickly. India does not plan to commence work on the bomb as yet because the government of India is convinced that CHICOMS (Communist Chinese) will not have an offensive nuclear capability for at least five years. In the meantime, should the situation change, India is relying on President Lyndon Johnson's assurance to come to the aid of any nation menaced by China. When Parliament convenes early in November, the government expects pressure from some deputies for India to produce a bomb. However, the government plans to resist these pressures.

A year later, when the Lal Bahadur Shastri government came to power and an Indo-Pak-istan war engulfed the region, the CIA worried that an Indian nuclear weapon programme was a certainty. William Raborn, the then CIA director, argued that proponents of a nuclear weapon programme were strengthened by the war, but the main trigger could be the political